

Intro to Comp Architecture

Quiz #4

Question #1:

Response Time:

response time is the total (latency) time required to complete one task or program

Response time = Time for one job to finish

Throughput:

throughput is the number of tasks completed in a given amount of time

$$\text{throughput} = \frac{\text{no of jobs completed}}{\text{unit time}}$$

e.g. A web server is upgraded with a faster network card (1 Gbps $\rightarrow$ 10 Gbps).
throughput increases because more requests can be handled per second, but if each request still requires some CPU processing time, the average response time per request remains unchanged.

Question #2:

(a) Performance Ratio

$$x = 20 \div 15 = 1.33$$

$$\text{Performance Ratio} = \frac{\text{Time}_2}{\text{Time}_1} = \frac{20}{15} = 1.333$$

4 is 1.33 times more faster than x.

(b) Improvement

$$\text{Improvement} = \frac{20-15}{20} \times 100\% = 25\%$$

4 is 25% faster than x.

Question #3:

(A) Iron Law

$$\text{CPU time} = \text{Instruction count} \times \text{CPI} \times \text{Clock period.}$$

Given: Instruction = 2×10^9

Machine A: CPI = 1.6, Clock period = $0.4 \text{ ns} = 0.4 \times 10^{-9}$

$$T_A = 2 \times 10^9 \times 1.6 \times 0.4 \times 10^{-9}$$

$$= 2 \times 1.6 \times 0.4$$

$$\boxed{T_A = 1.28 \text{ s}}$$

Machine B: CPI = 2.0, Clock period = $0.25 \text{ ns} = 0.25 \times 10^{-9}$

$$T_B = 2 \times 10^9 \times 2.0 \times 0.25 \times 10^{-9} = 2 \times 2.0 \times 0.25 = 1.0 \text{ second.}$$

$$(b) \frac{T_A}{T_B} = \frac{1.28}{1} = 1.28 \text{ s}$$

Machine B is 1.28 times faster than Machine A

Question #4:

• Before the floating point hardware:

• One floating point operation requires 50 cycles:

↳ 50 integer instructions

↳ Each instruction = 1 cycle

so instruction count = 50 and cycles = 50.

$$\text{MIPS} = \frac{\text{Instruction count}}{\text{Execution time} \times 10^6}$$

given clock rate: 1 MHz

$$\text{MIPS} = \frac{50}{50} = 1$$

1 MIPS

• After floating point hardware:

• same operation uses: 1 floating point instruction

↳ takes 2 cycles

so instruction count: 1

cycles: 2

$$\text{MIPS} = \frac{1}{2} = 0.5$$

$$\boxed{= 0.5 \text{ MIPS}}$$

MIPS decreased from 1 to 0.5 but execution time improved dramatically:

- Old execution: 50 cycles
- New execution: 2 cycles

Thus reduce the MIPS faster the actual performance.

MIPS can be misleading because it depends on instruction count not actual work completed.

Assignment #4

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Question #1:

(a) Weighted Mean = $w_1 r_1 + w_2 r_2$

$$\text{Machine 1: } (0.7)(8) + (0.3)(40) \\ = 5.6 + 12$$

$$\boxed{M_1 = 17.65}$$

$$\text{Machine 2: } (0.7 \times 4) + (0.3 \times 70) \\ = 2.8 + 21 = 23.8$$

$$\boxed{M_2 = 23.95}$$

(b) Overall Performance:

$$17.6 < 23.8$$

Machine 1 gives better overall performance

(c) Unweighted Arithmetic Mean

$$\text{Machine 1: } \frac{8+40}{2} = 24$$

$$\text{Machine 2: } \frac{4+70}{2} = 37$$

They would think Machine 1 is faster

Question #2:

(a) Total distance / total time

Time for 1st segment:

$$t_1 = \frac{20}{60} = \frac{1}{3} \text{ h}$$

Time for 2nd segment:

$$t_2 = \frac{20}{120} = \frac{1}{6} \text{ h}$$

$$\text{Total time} = \frac{1}{3} + \frac{1}{6} = \frac{1}{2} \text{ h}$$

$$\text{Total distance} = 20 + 20 = 40 \text{ km}$$

$$\text{Total speed} = \frac{40}{(1/2)} = 80 \text{ km/h}$$

(b) Harmonic Mean

for equal distance $\rightarrow$ harmonic mean is used:

$$H = \frac{2v_1 v_2}{v_1 + v_2} = \frac{2(40)(120)}{60 + 120} = \frac{14400}{18} = 80$$

$$H = 80 \text{ km/h}$$

$\therefore$ harmonic mean is used because speed ~~rate~~ is a rate and equal distances are travelled.

Question # 3:

(a) statement of Amman's law

Overall speed up $\Rightarrow$

$$S = \frac{1}{(1-f) + (f/s)}$$

f = fraction improved

s = speed factor

(b) overall speed up

Non vectorizable = 28%

vectorizable = 75%

speed up = 8

$$S = \frac{1}{0.25 + \frac{0.75}{8}} = \frac{1}{0.25 + 0.09375}$$

$$S = 2.091$$

(C) Maximum possible speedup

If $s \rightarrow \infty$

$$\frac{0.75}{\infty} = 0$$

$$S = \frac{1}{0.25} = 4$$

Limit exists because non vectorizable part 25% cannot be speed up, it becomes the bottle neck.

Question #4:

(i) Arithmetic Mean of Times

It is used when many execution times for same workload across machines (consistent with total times).

(ii) Harmonic mean of rates:

Correct for averaging rates (km/h, transaction/sec) when measuring same distance or task count, because total time = sum of

(distance / rate).

(iii) Geometric mean of ratios

Correct for normalizing performance relative to a reference machine especially for benchmark of different types because it avoids dependence on the reference choice.

Why arithmetic mean?

different reference of machines can produce contradictory conclusions:

e.g. machine A appears faster than B using one reference
• but slower than other reference

Arithmetic mean does not properly handle ratios.

Geometric mean avoids inconsistency and gives fair comparison results